SOURDOUGH BAGUETTE



YIELD	ACTIVE TIME	REST	TOTAL TIME
6 baguettes, or 3 Italian loaves	**15 min**	**1.5 h bulk, then 1.5-2 h shaped**	**about 4 h 45 min**

OVEN	ENERGY COST
450F, about 25 min	**$1.89 (25 min bake plus 30 min, 3.5 kW at 59 cents/kWh)**

INGREDIENTS

283 g	Water, lukewarm
481 g	Sourdough starter, ripe or discard
540-600 g	All-purpose flour
15 g	Table salt
2 tsp	Granulated sugar
	Instant yeast: 1-2 tsp, depending on how vigorous the starter is
4 tsp	Vital wheat gluten

METHOD

1. Combine the water, starter and 360 g of the flour until smooth.
2. Stir in the salt, sugar, yeast and gluten, then another 180 to 240 g of flour. Stop as soon as the dough pulls from the bowl sides. A slack, sticky dough gives a lighter loaf, so resist adding more.
3. Knead about 7 minutes in a mixer, or 8 to 10 by hand on a greased surface.
4. Rise in an oiled covered bowl until doubled, about 1.5 hours.
5. Deflate gently and divide into 6 for thin baguettes, or 3 for thicker Italian loaves.
6. Shape each into a 16 inch loaf. Space at least 4 inches apart on parchment, or use baguette pans and make them 15 inches.
7. Cover with greased plastic and rise 1.5 to 2 hours until puffy. Heat the oven to 450F toward the end.
8. Slash three diagonals about 1/4 inch deep. Skip the slashing if you want taller, rounder loaves.
9. Bake about 25 minutes to a rich golden brown, with steam if you can.
10. Turn the oven off, crack the door a few inches, and leave the loaves in to dry the crust.
11. Cool completely on a rack.

NOTES

481 g of starter against 540-600 g of flour is a very high proportion, which is why it still carries instant yeast for reliability.
Vital wheat gluten is doing structural work here, compensating for all-purpose rather than bread flour.
Keep the dough slack. Flouring it up to something comfortable costs you the open crumb.
The oven-off, door-cracked rest is what keeps the crust crisp rather than softening as it cools.
Store in paper, not plastic. Paper preserves the crust.
This is King Arthur's written Sourdough Baguettes recipe. The video linked was their "Artisan Sourdough Baguettes", a different title from the same publisher, so treat the quantities here as the written version rather than a transcript of the video.